



Change of guard: Shubman Gill has taken over as India's new ODI captain, replacing Rohit Sharma for the ongoing three-match series in Australia. AFP

handicapped by having to bowl with a ball made wet and slippery by the dew. So, the authorities can make the effort to have day games instead of day-night games whenever possible.

India found the wet ball tough to bowl with in the ongoing Women's World Cup and lost two games where they put up a big total, which they would have won if they had been played during the day. So, the toss made a difference. They still have a couple of games to play and qualify for the semis.

If they do get there, then the coach must tell

them to play smart cricket and not throw their wickets and the match away by going for the glory shots, whether batting first or chasing. Not too many Indian girls, apart from skipper Harmanpreet Kaur and Smriti Mandhana, are capable of smashing the sixes, so the others could be well advised to be less ambitious and not throw the game away looking for sixes and getting caught well inside the boundary. Otherwise, like it happened with the men's team, which at least got to the final, the fans will be heartbroken by another cup going somewhere else.



If anything, Gill will only benefit by having Rohit and Virat by his side. Both would be happy to offer suggestions if asked, and what could be better for a captain leading in this format for the first time than to have two of the greatest ODI players playing in his team?